

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Terrorism and Counter-Terror Architecture	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — DEFINITION ACTOR AND COERCIVE PURPOSE Read Definition actor and coercive purpose as a sequence: identify
02	FOUNDATION — TERRORISM INSURGENCY AND NAXALISM DISTINCTIONS Mechanism chain: State-proxy boundary Qualified use: Define each
03	FOUNDATION — STATE PROXIES DENIABILITY AND ATTRIBUTION Read State proves deniability and attribution as a sequence: identify
04	CORE — MANIFESTATIONS OF TERRORISM IN INDIA Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation,
05	CORE — FUNDING AND LOGISTICS ARCHITECTURE Mechanism chain: Counter-terror chain Qualified use: Map finance
06	CORE — PREVENTION RESPONSE INVESTIGATION PROSECUTION CHAIN Mechanism chain: Post-26/11 build-out - NIA boundary Qualified use:
07	CORE — POST-26/11 INSTITUTIONAL BUILD-OUT Mechanism chain: MAC-SMAC boundary Qualified use: Explain why
08	CORE — NIA JURISDICTION AND STATE-POLICE PRIMACY Mechanism chain: NATGRID boundary Qualified use: Pair national
09	CORE — MAC SMAC NATGRID AND INFORMATION SHARING Mechanism chain: NCTC federalism issue Qualified use: Keep
10	CORE — NCTC FEDERALISM AND CENTRALISATION DEBATE Mechanism chain: State-police primacy Qualified use: Balance
11	CORE — UAPA 2019 INDIVIDUAL DESIGNATION Read UAPA 2019 individual designation as a sequence: identify UAPA
12	CORE — DESIGNATION ARREST CHARGE-SHEET TRIAL CONVICTION Mechanism chain: NIA 2019 amendment Qualified use: Preserve
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — NIA AMENDMENT ACT 2019 AND SPECIAL COURTS Read NIA Amendment Act 2019 and Special Courts as a sequence:
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — BNS SECTION 113 UAPA AND BAIL REGIMES Mechanism chain: UAPA bail boundary - TADA-POTA precedent
15	CORE SYNTHESIS — PRAHAAR SEVEN ELEMENTS AND QUALIFIED COUNTER-TERROR ANSWER Read PRAHAAR seven elements and qualified counter-terror answer

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Terrorism definition?

A. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: A. Explanation: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q2. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Terrorism definition?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: B. Explanation: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q3. Which statement uses Terrorism definition without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

Answer: C. Explanation: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Terrorism definition?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: D. Explanation: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism?

A. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: A. Explanation: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q6. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

Answer: B. Explanation: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q7. Which statement uses Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism without changing its institution, law or status?

A. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. B. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. C. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. D. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

Answer: C. Explanation: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism?

A. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.

Answer: D. Explanation: Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies State-proxy boundary?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: A. Explanation: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q10. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of State-proxy boundary?

A. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. B. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: B. Explanation: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q11. Which statement uses State-proxy boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. C. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: C. Explanation: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about State-proxy boundary?

A. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. B. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. C. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: D. Explanation: A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Manifestation categories?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q14. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Manifestation categories?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q15. Which statement uses Manifestation categories without changing its institution, law or status?

A. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. D. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Manifestation categories?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Funding architecture?

A. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. B. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: A. Explanation: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q18. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Funding architecture?

A. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q19. Which statement uses Funding architecture without changing its institution, law or status?

A. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: C. Explanation: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Funding architecture?

A. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. B. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. C. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. D. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

Answer: D. Explanation: Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Counter-terror chain?

A. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. B. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: A. Explanation: The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q22. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Counter-terror chain?

A. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. B. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. C. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. D. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.

Answer: B. Explanation: The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q23. Which statement uses Counter-terror chain without changing its institution, law or status?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Counter-terror chain?

A. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. D. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: D. Explanation: The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Post-26/11 build-out?

A. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. B. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: A. Explanation: After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q26. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Post-26/11 build-out?

A. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. B. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: B. Explanation: After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q27. Which statement uses Post-26/11 build-out without changing its institution, law or status?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: C. Explanation: After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Post-26/11 build-out?

A. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. D. After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.

Answer: D. Explanation: After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies NIA boundary?

A. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. B. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. C. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q30. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NIA boundary?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. C. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. D. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q31. Which statement uses NIA boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. D. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NIA boundary?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies MAC-SMAC boundary?

A. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. B. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: A. Explanation: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q34. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of MAC-SMAC boundary?

A. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. B. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: B. Explanation: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q35. Which statement uses MAC-SMAC boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. D. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

Answer: C. Explanation: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MAC-SMAC boundary?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. D. MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.

Answer: D. Explanation: MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies NATGRID boundary?

A. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: A. Explanation: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q38. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NATGRID boundary?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

Answer: B. Explanation: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q39. Which statement uses NATGRID boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: C. Explanation: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NATGRID boundary?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. D. NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description.

Answer: D. Explanation: NATGRID is an intelligence data-linkage architecture; its operational status and accessible datasets require a dated official source and must not be inferred from a book-period description. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies NCTC federalism issue?

A. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

Answer: A. Explanation: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q42. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NCTC federalism issue?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. C. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. D. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

Answer: B. Explanation: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q43. Which statement uses NCTC federalism issue without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. D. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Answer: C. Explanation: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NCTC federalism issue?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. D. The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies State-police primacy?

A. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: A. Explanation: Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q46. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of State-police primacy?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. C. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. D. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

Answer: B. Explanation: Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q47. Which statement uses State-police primacy without changing its institution, law or status?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. D. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Answer: C. Explanation: Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about State-police primacy?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. C. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. D. Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Answer: D. Explanation: Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies UAPA 2019 designation?

A. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. B. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. C. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: A. Explanation: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q50. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of UAPA 2019 designation?

A. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. B. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. C. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. D. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Answer: B. Explanation: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q51. Which statement uses UAPA 2019 designation without changing its institution, law or status?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. C. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: C. Explanation: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument,

evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about UAPA 2019 designation?

A. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. B. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. C. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. D. The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

Answer: D. Explanation: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Designation-conviction firewall?

A. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: A. Explanation: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q54. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Designation-conviction firewall?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. C. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: B. Explanation: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q55. Which statement uses Designation-conviction firewall without changing its institution, law or status?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. C. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. D. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: C. Explanation: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. The other options change the threat

category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Designation-conviction firewall?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.

Answer: D. Explanation: Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies NIA 2019 amendment?

A. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: A. Explanation: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q58. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of NIA 2019 amendment?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. C. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. D. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.

Answer: B. Explanation: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q59. Which statement uses NIA 2019 amendment without changing its institution, law or status?

A. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. B. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. C. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. D. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: C. Explanation: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NIA 2019 amendment?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.

Answer: D. Explanation: The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies BNS-UAPA concurrency?

A. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: A. Explanation: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q62. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of BNS-UAPA concurrency?

A. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. B. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: B. Explanation: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q63. Which statement uses BNS-UAPA concurrency without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. B. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. C. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. D. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about BNS-UAPA concurrency?

A. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. B. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. C. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. D. BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.

Answer: D. Explanation: BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies UAPA bail boundary?

A. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. B. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: A. Explanation: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q66. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of UAPA bail boundary?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q67. Which statement uses UAPA bail boundary without changing its institution, law or status?

A. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. B. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. C. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: C. Explanation: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about UAPA bail boundary?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.

Answer: D. Explanation: UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies TADA-POTA precedent?

A. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. B. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. C. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. D. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q70. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of TADA-POTA precedent?

A. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. B. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. C. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. D. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.

Answer: B. Explanation: TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q71. Which statement uses TADA-POTA precedent without changing its institution, law or status?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: C. Explanation: TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about TADA-POTA precedent?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. D. TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Answer: D. Explanation: TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies PRAHAAR policy?

A. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: A. Explanation: PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q74. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of PRAHAAR policy?

A. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. B. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. C. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. D. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.

Answer: B. Explanation: PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q75. Which statement uses PRAHAAR policy without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. C. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: C. Explanation: PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PRAHAAR policy?

A. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. D. PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.

Answer: D. Explanation: PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Policy-agency-outcome firewall?

A. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. B. Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. C. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: A. Explanation: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q78. Which option preserves the legal or institutional boundary of Policy-agency-outcome firewall?

A. Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. B. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. C. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: B. Explanation: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q79. Which statement uses Policy-agency-outcome firewall without changing its institution, law or status?

A. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. B. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. C. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. D. A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.

Answer: C. Explanation: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Policy-agency-outcome firewall?

A. Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. B. The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. C. The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. D. PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The other options change the threat category, institutional owner, legal instrument, evidentiary rung or implementation status.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

AUDITED TOPIC-SPECIFIC PYQ OWNERSHIP

The owner and audited GS-III ledgers route the 2019 UAPA/NIA amendment demand, the 2021 terrorism-complexity demand and the 2025 manifestation/counter-measures demand here. No objective key or unverified contemporary incident attribution is supplied.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III

Demand: UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment.

Status: Audited neutral rendering; Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words. The owner and OCR paper verify the routed demand.

Model solution: NIA boundary: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **NCTC federalism issue:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA 2019 designation:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Designation-conviction firewall:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **NIA 2019 amendment:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **TADA-POTA precedent:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: NIA boundary: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **NCTC federalism issue:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA 2019 designation:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Designation-conviction firewall:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **NIA 2019 amendment:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **TADA-POTA precedent:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: Audited neutral rendering; Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words. The owner and OCR paper verify the routed demand. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: NIA boundary: The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **NCTC federalism issue:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA 2019 designation:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Designation-conviction firewall:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **NIA 2019 amendment:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **TADA-POTA precedent:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III

Demand: Terrorism complexity, causes, linkages, nexus and measures for eradication.

Status: Audited neutral rendering; Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words.

Model solution: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Funding architecture:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit

currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Funding architecture:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: Terrorism complexity, causes, linkages, nexus and measures for eradication. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: Audited neutral rendering; Analyse · 15 marks · 250 words. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last

three. **Funding architecture:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **State-police primacy:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **UAPA bail boundary:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2021 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 GS-III

Demand: "Terrorism is a global scourge. How has it manifested in India? Elaborate with contemporary examples. What are the counter measures adopted by the State? Explain."

Status: Verbatim owner-preserved question; Elaborate/Explain · 10 marks · 150 words.

Model solution: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Post-26/11 build-out:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **NIA boundary:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **MAC-SMAC boundary:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **PRAHAAR policy:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 GS-III', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed

international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Post-26/11 build-out:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **NIA boundary:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **MAC-SMAC boundary:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **PRAHAAR policy:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Demand: "Terrorism is a global scourge. How has it manifested in India? Elaborate with contemporary examples. What are the counter measures adopted by the State? Explain." **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Status: Verbatim owner-preserved question; Elaborate/Explain · 10 marks · 150 words. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Terrorism definition: Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **State-proxy boundary:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Manifestation categories:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Counter-terror chain:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Post-26/11 build-out:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **NIA boundary:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **MAC-SMAC boundary:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **PRAHAAR policy:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Policy-agency-outcome firewall:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. The solution therefore answers the routed demand without

inventing an official model answer or an objective answer key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 GS-III', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism in India's internal-security discourse. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.
- Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms.
- The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on 'Distinguish terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism in India's internal-security discourse. Answer...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.

Analysis: This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:**

Terrorism-insurgency-Naxalism. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the broad coercive category, insurgency is armed rebellion with a claimed social base, and Naxalism is Maoist guerrilla violence aimed at capturing state power; the terms are not synonyms. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories.

Named evidence/example: The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Distinguish terrorism, insurgency and Naxalism in India's internal-security discourse. Answer...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the prevention-to-prosecution counter-terror chain and the institutions at each stage. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.
- The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.
- MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal

instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on 'Explain the prevention-to-prosecution counter-terror chain and the institutions at each...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor ->

prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

3. **Claim:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Explain the prevention-to-prosecution counter-terror chain and the institutions at each...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Analyse the UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA 2019 amendment. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** TADA-POTA precedent. **Named evidence/example:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.
- The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.
- The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

- Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.
- The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts.
- UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
- TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: NIA 2019 amendment. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: TADA-POTA precedent. **Named evidence/example:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on 'Analyse the UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment. Answer in...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first

response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA 2019 amendment. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** TADA-POTA precedent. **Named evidence/example:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

3. **Claim:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
7. **Claim:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first

and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation.

Named evidence/example: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA 2019 amendment. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019 extends jurisdiction to specified offences outside India affecting Indian citizens or interests, expands scheduled coverage and permits Sessions Courts to be designated Special Courts. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** TADA-POTA precedent. **Named evidence/example:** TADA operated from 1985 to 1995 and POTA from 2002 to 2004 before lapse or repeal amid misuse concerns, illustrating the recurring necessity-accountability tension in special anti-terror law. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Analyse the UAPA and NIA Act amendments in the prevailing security environment. Answer in...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine India's cooperative-federal counter-terror architecture with reference to the NCTC controversy. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Post-26/11 build-out. **Named evidence/example:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not

arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions.
- The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role.
- MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.
- The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Post-26/11 build-out. **Named evidence/example:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on 'Examine India's cooperative-federal counter-terror architecture with reference to the NCTC...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Post-26/11 build-out. **Named evidence/example:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify

centralisation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

5. **Claim:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Post-26/11 build-out. **Named evidence/example:** After the 2008 Mumbai attacks, NIA was created, MAC was strengthened, NATGRID was proposed, NCTC was debated, NSG hubs were added and coastal-security arrangements were revamped; these bodies have different functions. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NIA boundary. **Named evidence/example:** The NIA Act, 2008 creates a central investigating agency for scheduled offences with concurrent jurisdiction; NIA does not replace the local police's first response, evidence preservation or ordinary policing role. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Examine India's cooperative-federal counter-terror architecture with reference to the NCTC...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse terrorism's causes, linkages and finance-logistics nexus and suggest a calibrated response.
Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-proxy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Funding architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition.
- A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record.
- The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three.
- Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10.

- The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.
- UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
- PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.
- PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-proxy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Funding architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on 'Analyse terrorism's causes, linkages and finance-logistics nexus and suggest a calibrated...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: State-proxy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Funding architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

3. **Claim:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
5. **Claim:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
6. **Claim:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
7. **Claim:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
8. **Claim:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Terrorism definition. **Named evidence/example:** Terrorism is the planned, organised and systematic use of violence as coercion for political, religious or ideological purposes; the owner notes the absence of a universally agreed international definition. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-proxy boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A nominally non-state organisation may receive state finance, sanctuary, logistics or training; proxy use creates deniability but current attribution still requires a dated competent-agency record. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and

notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Manifestation categories. **Named evidence/example:** The owner's India framework separates hinterland terrorism, Jammu and Kashmir militancy, North-East insurgency and Left-Wing Extremism, with dedicated owners for the last three. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Funding architecture. **Named evidence/example:** Terror funding may involve state sponsorship, extortion, taxation, hawala, counterfeit currency, contraband, charities or organised-crime links; each channel requires separate evidence and belongs in detail to Topic 10. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Analyse terrorism's causes, linkages and finance-logistics nexus and suggest a calibrated...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically evaluate PRAHAAR as a policy framework for contemporary terrorism while preserving federalism and rights. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** BNS-UAPA concurrency. **Named evidence/example:** BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience.
- MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands.
- The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation.
- Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases.
- The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route.

- Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt.
- BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked.
- UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately.
- PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience.
- PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** BNS-UAPA concurrency. **Named evidence/example:** BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** PRAHAAR policy. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR, released by MHA on 23 February 2026, is a national counter-terrorism policy and strategy organised around prevention, response, capacity aggregation, human rights and rule of law, attenuating conditions, international alignment, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy

implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on 'Critically evaluate PRAHAAR as a policy framework for contemporary terrorism while preserving...', each clause, threat mechanism, named Indian law/institution, dated status, federal-rights boundary, outcome and qualification.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication.

Qualification: The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation.

Named evidence/example: The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Claim: BNS-UAPA concurrency. **Named evidence/example:** BNS section 113, in force from 1 July 2024, defines terrorist act in general penal law while UAPA remains the special law; an officer not below SP rank decides which route is invoked. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA bail boundary. **Named evidence/example:** UAPA section 43D(5) creates a stringent prima-facie-true bail threshold; pre-trial liberty, prosecution and conviction must be analysed separately. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

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implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Policy-agency-outcome firewall. **Named evidence/example:** PRAHAAR is a policy framework working through existing institutions; a policy release, search, seizure, arrest or charge-sheet is not a new agency, conviction, reduced-incident figure or verified prevention outcome. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
2. **Claim:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
3. **Claim:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
4. **Claim:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
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6. **Claim:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Named evidence/example:** Identify the exact Indian law, institution, accord, judgment, force, system or dated case-status anchor owned by the source. **Analysis:** Connect threat mechanism -> competent actor -> prevention/response route -> security or development consequence. **Qualification:** State jurisdiction, source/date/status, legal character, intelligence/evidence limit, rights safeguard, implementation gap or residual risk.
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Counter-position / limit: Announcement, designation, alert, arrest, seizure, ceasefire, framework agreement, sanction, procurement or deployment cannot alone establish conviction, final settlement, operational readiness, deterrence, resilience or development outcome; test mandate, process, status and evidence.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Counter-terror chain. **Named evidence/example:** The response chain separates prevention and intelligence, containment and specialised response, investigation by NIA or State police, prosecution in competent courts, finance disruption, and recovery or resilience. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** MAC-SMAC boundary. **Named evidence/example:** MAC and SMAC are intelligence-sharing and coordination platforms, not arresting, investigating or prosecuting commands. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** NCTC federalism issue. **Named evidence/example:** The proposed NCTC faced objection because independent search, arrest and investigation powers under an intelligence body could bypass State policing competence; the coordination need did not automatically justify centralisation. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** State-police primacy. **Named evidence/example:** Local police ordinarily reach an attack first and secure the scene, witnesses, evidence and public order, making State capacity structurally irreplaceable even in nationally investigated cases. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** UAPA 2019 designation. **Named evidence/example:** The UAPA (Amendment) Act, 2019 permits the Central Government to designate an individual as a terrorist in the Fourth Schedule through executive notification and a statutory review or denotification route. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:** The conclusion retains the owner's date, institution, legal character and notification-to-implementation status boundary. **Claim:** Designation-conviction firewall. **Named evidence/example:** Individual designation, arrest, charge-sheet, trial and conviction are five distinct legal and evidentiary events; designation is not a judicial finding of guilt. **Analysis:** This fixes the threat category, legal instrument, institutional mandate and verified evidentiary rung before drawing the policy implication. **Qualification:**

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Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/threat -> mechanism -> law/institution -> prevention/response -> outcome/accountability; write four to seven claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, status, jurisdiction and intelligence/evidence checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, uses India-centric evidence, and preserves legal character, institutional mandate, process stage, federal boundary, rights safeguard and security-development distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For 'Critically evaluate PRAHAAR as a policy framework for contemporary terrorism while preserving...', replace the weakest generic point with one exact statutory or institutional mechanism, named India-centric example, dated status, implementation bottleneck, accountability safeguard and answer-specific qualification.